School of Computer and Information Sciences

COURSE SYLLABUS

Course Information

ITS831 - B02 InfoTech Import in Strat Plan
Fall 2025 Second Bi-Term
Course Format: Online
CRN: 2025-FALL-2BT-ITS-831-B02
Class Time and Location: Online

Instructor Information

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Office Location: Remote
Office Hours/Preferred Contact Times: Flexible - email or text me for an appointment

Course Description

This course focuses on the information technology leader's collaborative roles working with an organization's senior leadership, including aligning business strategy with IT strategy, acting as an equal contributor to the formation of organizational strategy, and integrating ethical policies and practices into an organization. Learners evaluate multidisciplinary research and practices related to leadership, organizational structures, and culture. Through the lens of complexity/chaos and change theories, learners analyze information technology's role in contributing to organizational resiliency.

Course Objectives

Upon completion of this course:

- Students will be proactive with risk management practices
- Students will understand IT business management
- Students will understand the basics of Blockchain technology
- Students will understand the economics of cloud computing
- Students will understand the benefits of eco-efficient technology adoption
- Students will understand how to balance customer and shareholder value
- Students will understand how emerging technologies affect strategic planning

Learner Outcomes

- Learn how to perform research identifying and analyzing technological challenges
- Build critical thinking skills to develop and apply solutions that achieve strategic and tactical IT-business alignment
- Develop professional skills and expertise to advance knowledge in your chosen field or discipline within information technology
- Conduct research with professional and ethical integrity
- Address complex technical questions and challenge established knowledge and practices in the area
- Identify, comprehend, analyze, evaluate and synthesize research
- Communicate effectively and employ constructive professional and interpersonal skills
- Critically evaluate current research and best practices
- Demonstrate IT leadership skills at the team and enterprise levels following tenets of professional, social, and ethical responsibility

- Recommend IT strategies that support enterprise mission and objectives

Course Website

Access to the course website is required via the iLearn portal on the University of the Cumberlands website: http://www.ucumberlands.edu/ilearn/ or https://ucumberlands.blackboard.com/

Required Books and Resources

Title: None Required

To access your course materials, simply click on the Course Materials link located on the content page of your course in iLearn.

Suggested Books and Resources

Writing Center
Website: https://www.ucumberlands.edu/learningcommons/writingcenter
About: This website includes beginning information about the Writing Center. Look for The Learning Commons in your class list in iLearn. Once you open The Learning Commons "course", look for the Writing Center on the left menu bar

Academic Writer
Website: http://ucumberlands.libguides.com/c.php?g=504168
About: This is APA's resource for APA format, style, citations, and document types (like how to write a literature review). UC has a dedicated link for students to create their Academic Writer account, and that link can be found here

The Learning Commons (TLC)
Website: http://ucumberlands.libguides.com/c.php?g=504168
About: TLC is here to help you succeed in your courses, from your first day at Cumberlands through completing your degree.TLC offers a variety of academic resources both virtually and in-person that are informal and with qualified Academic Fellows.

Grammarly
Website: https://www.grammarly.com/
About: Compose bold, clear, mistake-free writing with Grammarly's AI-powered writing assistant

Zotero
Website: https://www.zotero.org/
About: Zotero is a great, easy to use reference management tool, and it's free

Requirements and Policies

Academic Dishonesty Policy

As a Christian liberal arts university committed to the pursuit of truth and understanding, any act of academic dishonesty is especially distressing and cannot be tolerated. In general, academic dishonesty involves the abuse and misuse of information or people to gain an undeserved academic advantage or evaluation.

The common forms of academic dishonesty include:

1. cheating – using deception in the taking of tests or the preparation of written work, using unauthorized materials, copying another person's work with or without consent, or assisting another in such activities;
2. lying – falsifying, fabricating, or forging information in either written or spoken presentations;
3. plagiarism – using the published writings, data, interpretations, or ideas of another without proper documentation.
4. multiple submissions - submitting the same academic written or oral work for which credit was previously received, without the approval of the instructor.

Episodes of academic dishonesty are reported as appropriate to the Vice President for Academic Affairs. The potential penalty for academic dishonesty includes 1) a failing grade on a particular assignment, 2) a failing grade for the entire course, 3) suspension or expulsion, or (4) revocation of a degree.

Attendance Policy

Course enrollment and participation will be monitored and verified for all students during the first two weeks of classes. Lack of participation during this time may jeopardize enrollment status. Each student is expected to meet course expectations by completing the coursework required each week. Active participation and staying abreast of the material is essential to success. Program specific attendance policies may still apply.

Study after study has linked successful academic performance with good class participation. Those who assume positions of responsibility must "show up" in order to be effective. Therefore, students are expected to actively participate in an intelligent discussion of assigned topics in all areas (Discussion Board Activities, Synchronous Sessions, Forums, Shared Papers, etc.) to help process course material and/or to demonstrate understanding of course content. Point adjustments will be taken for non-participation.

It is expected for students to participate at least two (2) times in addition to their original Discussion board post on three different days to demonstrate participation. Discussions will not re-open once closed.

Course Evaluations

The course evaluation will be open during the last two weeks of the term. To access the evaluation (during that time), visit https://uofcumberlands.campuslabs.com/eval-home/ and log-in using your UC credentials. A reminder email notification will be sent when the evaluation is available.

We value your feedback. Every evaluation is confidential and anonymous. The anonymous results of the course evaluations are not available for faculty to see until after final grades are submitted. Your thoughtful responses guide future improvements for the course and programs.

Disability Accommodations

University of the Cumberlands accepts students with certified disabilities and provides reasonable accommodations for their certified needs in the classroom, in housing, in food service or in other areas. For accommodations to be awarded, a student must submit a completed Accommodations Application form and provide documentation of the disability to the Disability Services Coordinator (Shirley Stephens, Gatliff Administration Building, Room 114, accommodations@ucumberlands.edu). When appropriate documentation is on file, approved accommodations will be shared with the student. Each term, students with current academic accommodations will be sent an email to share with their instructors. Accommodations are generally not retroactive. For temporary accommodations such as illness or other approved absences, please use the Temporary Accommodations form. Certifications for other accommodations are normally reviewed annually.

Student Responsibilities

Students should:

- Use University of the Cumberlands email system for all academic, administrative, and co-curricular communication between faculty, staff and peers.

- Check for email and class announcements using iLearn (primary) and University of the Cumberlands webmail (secondary) daily.
- Demonstrate Cumberlands Character in and outside the classroom per the University Mission & Vision
- Ensure you have consistent required technology for the course
- Participate in courses regularly to:
    - Find announcements and updates
    - Complete assignments on time. Keep in mind that all deadlines use Eastern Standard Time (EST).
    - Engage in discussion
    - Connect with fellow students and faculty
- Present written work in an academic and professional manner.
- Take examinations on the designated dates and times. Students should make arrangements with faculty before the designated date for any needed accommodations.
- Contact faculty or student success coordinator with questions or concerns.

Academic Appeal

Both undergraduate and graduate students have the right to challenge a grade. Before filing a formal appeal, the student must discuss the grade with the course instructor and department chair. If discussions with the course instructor and department chair do not lead to a satisfactory conclusion, students may file a formal written appeal with the Vice President for Academic Affairs, who will forward the appeal to the chair of the Academic Appeals Committee.

This formal written appeal to challenge a grade must be filed four weeks after the last day of class for the semester in which the course being appealed occurred. The Academic Appeals Committee then reviews the student's written appeal and gathers information from the instructor and any other relevant parties. The Committee will deliver its recommendation on the complaint to the Vice President for Academic Affairs. After reviewing this recommendation and concurring or amending it, the Vice President for Academic Affairs will inform the student and instructor of the disposition of the complaint no later than the last day of classes of the term in which the complaint was filed.

Records of all actions regarding academic grade appeals, including their final disposition, are maintained by the Vice President for Academic Affairs and the Academic Appeals Committee.

- The only authorized electronic means of academic, administrative, and co-curricular communication between University of the Cumberlands and its students is through the

UCumberlands email system (i.e. Webmail). Each student is responsible for monitoring his/her University email account frequently. This is the primary email account used to correspond with you directly by the University; imperative program information is sent to this email account specifically from campus and program office.

- Students should check for e-mail and class announcements using iLearn (primary) and University of the Cumberlands webmail (secondary).
- Students are expected to find out class assignments for missed classes and make up missed work.
- Students are expected to find out if any changes have been made in the class or assignment schedule.
- Written work must be presented in a professional manner. Work that is not submitted in a professional manner will not be evaluated and will be returned as unacceptable.
    - There is a craft to writing. Spelling, grammar, punctuation and diction (word usage) are all tools of that craft. Writing at the collegiate level will show careful attention to these elements of craft. Work that does not exhibit care with regard to these elements will be considered as inadequate for college writing and graded accordingly.
- Students are expected to take the examinations on the designated dates. If you are unable to take the exam on the scheduled date and know in advance, you are to make arrangements with your professor before the designated date. If you miss the exam, you must have a legitimate reason as determined by your professor.

Recognizing that a large part of professional life is meeting deadlines, it is necessary to develop time management and organizational skills. Failure to meet the course deadlines may result in penalties. Keep in mind that all deadlines are set using Eastern Standard Time (EST). **Late assignments will NOT be accepted.**

Students are expected to:

- Review any assigned reading material and prepare responses to homework assigned.
- Actively participate in activities, assignments, and discussions.
- Evaluate and react to each other's work in a supportive, constructive manner.
- Complete specific assignments and exams when specified and in a professional manner.
- Utilize learned technologies for class assignments.
- Connect content knowledge from core courses to practical training placement and activities.
- **All submissions are final after the assignment has been graded.**

Links to Support

UC Academic Catalog: https://www.ucumberlands.edu/academics/academic-catalog
UC Student Handbook: https://www.ucumberlands.edu/student-handbook
Academic Resources & Writing Center: www.ucumberlands.edu/learningcommons
Library: http://www.ucumberlands.edu/library/
Bookstore: https://cumber.bncollege.com/shop/cumberlands/home
About University of the Cumberlands: https://www.ucumberlands.edu/about/presidents-welcome
Instructions for Accessing, Downloading, and Activating Office 365 Pro Plus (free for UC Students): https://helpdesk.ucumberlands.edu/support/solutions/articles/7000045435

Course Evaluation

	Category	Qty	Pts Each	Total Pts
	Discussions	5	1@10 3@30 1@40	140
	Papers	5	75	375
	AI Risk Management Exercise	1	200	200
	Zero Trust Data Classification Worksheet	1	115	115
	Practical Connection Assignment	1	50	50
	Case Studies	2	60	120
	Total			**1000**

Student Course Concern Early Detection Form

Students can use the Early Detection form to share concerns about their courses with program administration and Academic Affairs. Concerns will be reviewed, and your name will not be shared with the professor unless you grant permission first. The form is not a course evaluation but a place to communicate concerns related to delayed grading beyond 7 days of the assignment's due date, faculty not responding to emails (no response in over 36 hours), or folders or content unavailable.

If you are uncomfortable completing the form, please contact your student success coordinator or academicaffairs@ucumberlands.edu.

Use this Early Detection Form to submit your concerns.

Grading Scale

Graded work will receive a numeric score reflecting the quality of performance as given above in evaluation methods. The overall course grade will be determined according to the following scale:

A = 90 – 100 (90% - 100%)
B = 80 – 89.9 (80% - 89.9%)
C = 70 – 79.9 (70% - 79.9%)
F ≤ 69.9 (Below 69.9%)

Syllabus Disclaimer

This syllabus contains important information critical to your success in this course. It includes guidelines for this course and the instructor's current expectations about content, schedule, and requirements necessary for each student to achieve the best educational results. While you must review and become familiar with the contents of this syllabus, the instructor reserves the right to make adjustments or change in the syllabus from time to time. Any changes to the syllabus will be discussed with the students.

Course Schedule

ates	Topics/Readings	Assignments and (Point Values)

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Week 1 **- Oct. 20**	• Textbook Chapter 1: The Information Systems Strategy Triangle • Textbook Chapter 2: Strategic Use of Information Resources • Al, M.Y.H.S., Abdulrab, M., Alwaheeb, M.A., Shamsuddin, A., & Jazim, F. (2022). The impact of technological capability on manufacturing companies: A review. *Journal of Public Affairs, 22*(1), 1-12. • Ricardo A Santa, Alejandro Acosta, Silvio Borrero, & Annibal Scavarda. (2020). Corporate, operational, and information systems strategies: Alignment and firm performance. *Estudios Gerenciales*, *36*(157), 454–464.	Student Introductions Discussion (10 points) Paper 1: Aligning IT Strategies (75 points) Optional Quiz Module 1 (0 points)
Week 2 **- Oct 27**	• George, A. S., & George, A. H. (2024). Riding the wave: An exploration of emerging technologies reshaping modern industry. *Partners Universal International Innovation Journal, 2*(1), 15–30. • Tseitkin, S. (2025, February 18). The four horsemen of emerging tech: How quantum computing, AI, blockchain, and cybersecurity are shaping the future. *KBI Media*. • NIST AI Risk Management Framework	Discussion 1: Emerging Technologies (30 points) AI Risk Management Exercise (200 points)
Week 3 **- Nov 3**	• Textbook Chapter 3: Organizational Strategy and Information Systems • Baskoro, T. (2024). Digital disruption: Landscape of e-business for competitive advantage. *Advances in Business & Industrial Marketing Research, 2*(1).	Discussion 2: Gaining Competitive Advantage through Innovation Video Pitch (40 points) Paper 2: Navigating Market Disruptions (7 points) Optional Quiz Module 3 (0 points)

ates	Topics/Readings	Assignments and (Point Values)
Week 4 - **Nov 10**	• Textbook Chapter 7: Cybersecurity • Textbook Chapter 9: Information Technology Governance • Babalola, O., & Folorunso, A. (2025). *A* governance framework model for cloud computing: Role of AI, security, compliance, and management. *ResearchGate.* • NIST Special Publication 800-53 Revision 5: Security and Privacy Controls for Information Systems and Organizations (*See Control Family SR: Pages 331-349*)	Discussion 3: Balancing Innovation and Compliance: Supply Chain Risk Management Controls (30 points) Paper 3: IT Governance, Compliance, anc Emerging Technologies (75 points) Optional Quiz Module 4 (0 points)
Week 5 **- Nov 17**	• Textbook Chapter 6: Architecture and Infrastructure • Textbook Chapter 7: Cybersecurity • Levine, A., & Tucker, B. A. (2022, July). Zero trust architecture: Trend and impact on information security. *International Journal of Emerging Technology and Advanced Engineering, 12*(7), 140-147. • GSA CyberEd Series: Using Zero Trust To Overcome Emerging Tech Challenges. Facilitated by Forrester. • CISA Zero Trust Maturity Model	Case Study 1: Applying AI to Achieve Optimal Zero Trust Architecture Maturity (points) Zero Trust Data Classification Worksheet (115 points) Optional Quiz Module 5 (0 points)
Week 6 **- Nov 24**	• Textbook Chapter 12: Business Intelligence, Artificial Intelligence, Knowledge Management, and Analytics • Textbook Chapter 5: Information Systems and Digital Transformation • Gulyamov, S. S., Xabibullaev, D., Musaev, B., Suyunova, D., Sartaeva, S., & Juraev, J. (2024). Predictive analytics for workforce planning in the context of digital transformation of manufacturing. *2024 6th International Conference on Control Systems, Mathematical Modeling, Automation and Energy Efficiency (SUMMA)*.	Case Study 2: Data-Driven Decision-Maki in Strategic Planning/Predictive Analytics points) Practical Connection Assignment (50 poin Optional Quiz Module 6 (0 points)

ates	Topics/Readings	Assignments and (Point Values)
Week 7 **- Dec 1**	• Textbook Chapter 11: Managing IT Projects	Discussion 4: Project Management (30 points) Paper 4: Strategic and Economic Implications of IS Outsourcing (75 points) Optional Quiz Module 7 (0 points)
Week 8 **- Dec 8**	• Textbook Chapter 13: Privacy, Ethical, and Societal Considerations for Information Management • Diab, B., & El Hajj, M. (2024). Ethics in the age of artificial intelligence: unveiling challenges and opportunities in business culture. *Cogent Business & Management*, *11*(1). • Patel, S. (2023). Data privacy and the legal implications of emerging technologies. *Journal of Emerging Technologies and Innovative Research, 10*(11), 220-245.	Paper 5: ChatGPT (75 points) Optional Quiz Module 8 (0 points)